

Skills Summary

Measuring with Units: Gaps and Overlaps

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Fix a count with gaps or overlaps

Rule: Units must sit end to end.

- Gaps skip some length → the count is too SMALL → add the hidden units back.
- Overlaps count some length twice → the count is too BIG → take the extra units away.

Example: Sam overlapped blocks, counting 2 too many. His count was 9 blocks. What is the real length?

Step 1. Overlaps make a count too big — so the fix is to take the extra blocks away.

Step 2. $9 - 2 = 7$.

⇒ the real length is **7** blocks

Try it: Pia left gaps that hid 2 clips. She counted 8 clips. What is the real length?

check: 10 clips

(!) Watch out: A wrong measuring count is not fixed by measuring louder — look at HOW the units were laid down. Ask: did any unit overlap? Was any length left bare?

Compare two measurements

Rule: Measure both things with the SAME unit. Then compare the counts: more units means longer, and subtracting the counts tells you by how much.

Example: The pencil is 9 cubes long and the pen is 6 cubes long. How many cubes longer is the pencil?

Step 1. Both counts use the same unit, so the difference of the counts is the difference in length.

Step 2. $9 - 6 = 3$.

⇒ the pencil is **3** cubes longer

Try it: One string is 12 clips long, another is 7 clips long. How many clips longer is the first?

check: 5 clips